



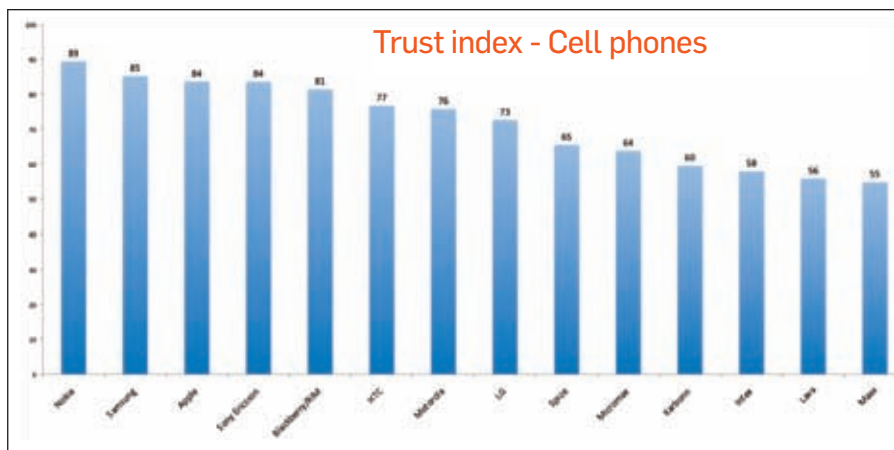
Lego's MINDriod

The Android app MINDriod allows users to remotely control Lego's Mindstorm NXT robots

Smooth talking nerds

The Conversacube is a device that helps nerds make conversation with people by giving them cues of what to talk about next

Trust index - Cell phones



- 5) People felt Nokia make the sturdiest devices – lasting longer than others.
- 6) Apple was voted as the most innovative brand. Nokia scored a close second, while Samsung and Blackberry tie for a distant third. Apple was also voted as the most technologically advanced brand. Interestingly Blackberry came in second here.
- 7) People don't find the smaller brands to be as innovative. Micromax led the minnows, but still only got one-fourth of the votes that Apple did.
- 8) Nokias were undisputedly voted as the easiest phones to use. Interestingly, Samsung and Apple score second and third, respectively. Perhaps the touch interface hasn't caught on as much as we thought.
- 9) Most Nokia users said they'd happily buy another Nokia when upgrading. Apple came second here.
- 10) Generally, more people were happy with their Nokia phones, and they felt their devices were well priced, and offered a comparatively better feature set. When asked, they also said that they found buying a Nokia phone relatively hassle-free, due to an abundance of supply. Additionally, servicing of Nokia phones was cheaper, and dealing with their customer support was also a better experience. Sony Ericsson and Samsung were the next most preferred brands on these counts.
- 11) From the minnows' point of view, one thing is quite heartening. When looking at perceived value of owning a cell phone belonging to a particular brand, there's not much separating the bigger brands

from the small ones. This means quite a few people are satisfied with their Micromax's, Intex's and the like.

The most trusted

Nokia wins again. But then the momentum they've gained over the past five years will take even longer to whittle down, if at all, so this comes as no surprise. However, globally, other brands have taken a larger chunk out of their sales pie, and our survey seems to indicate this too. Apple is gaining ground, and gradually improving on their iPhone design. Sony Ericsson is also an omnipresent threat, with a multitude of handsets catering to a wide audience. Riding the Android wave we have Motorola, HTC and Samsung, closing in, but still a bit behind. Windows Phone 7 could be another catalyst for these brands to further close the gap. Let's see how the next year pans out.

HDTVs

LCD and plasma TVs have taken over the market. Just visit any of the electronics chains in the country, and you'll see flat panels dominate the show. However, there's a lot of jargon flying around and often one doesn't know which brand to trust.

Market watch

This year has not been the year of the HDTV. That was last year. However, this year has been the year of market penetration, as we see more and more people opting for a flat-screen and chucking out their older TVs. Most importantly, this year has been a year of falling prices, especially of the larger sets. We've seen 32-inch TVs from brands like Samsung, LG, Sony and Philips fall from their lofty ₹40,000 prices, to ₹30,000. An even larger drop is in the 42-inch segment that has fallen to below ₹55,000, making it even more affordable.

3D televisions have appeared this year, and most of the big vendors are offering them. While market adoption is yet to pick up, the pricing of such displays has become more competitive. There's a dearth of 3D content, but on account of future proofing, if the premium's not too great, it's a nice feature to have. We've also seen brands like Videocon and Moserbaer become more competitive by offering better models that are slowly reaching the level of the big players like Samsung, LG and Sony.

LED TVs have become cheaper, and there are more options available. Full LED displays are slowly entering our market, as options to the inferior Edge LED models.

Trust index - HDTVs

